

7A GRAMMAR permission, obligation, and necessity

a Right (✓) or wrong (X)? Correct the mistakes in the **bold** phrases.

- 1 These shoes are too tight. I **should have tried** them on before buying them. ✓
- 2 Emma's still very upset about the argument, so you **hadn't better ask her** about it.
- 3 The invitation said we **didn't need to wear** formal clothes, so we wore jeans.
- 4 Employees **don't have to download** any software as it's against company rules.
- 5 We're **supposed to finish** early on Fridays, but we always end up staying late.
- 6 If you want to be sure of passing your exam, you really **ought study more**.
- 7 The boss is in a bad mood today, so you **better watch out**.
- 8 You **don't need to show** your passport for domestic travel within the UK.
- 9 We **ought to think** of that solution earlier. It's too late now.
- 10 You **needn't have washed up**, but thank you anyway.

b Circle the correct alternative in each pair. Tick (✓) if both are possible.

Customer Hi, my laptop hasn't been working properly for a few days now. Could you help?

Technician Yes, of course. First of all, I'd ¹**need to** / **need** look at it. Have you brought it with you?

Customer Yes, here it is. It's been really slow since I opened up an email attachment. I know I ²**mustn't** / **shouldn't** have done that, but I did and now I feel really stupid – I just wasn't thinking.

Technician Mmm, we always tell people that you're ³**not supposed to** / **not meant to** open up attachments unless you know who the sender is, but people do. The other thing we always tell customers is that they ⁴**mustn't** / **don't have to** forget to back up their files before they bring a laptop in, just in case we have to reinstall programs. You have backed yours up, haven't you?

Customer Oh yes, I've done that. But what do you think the problem is?

Technician I'm just having a look now, but you ⁵**needn't to** / **don't need to** worry...Right, got it. The memory on the laptop is full and that's why it's been working so slowly. Try restarting it first. That will clear the memory and reset the programs. Also, you ⁶**should** / **ought to** delete any apps that you don't need. That will free up some memory.

Customer Is there anything else that I ⁷**could** / **may** do?

Technician It's probably worth scanning for viruses.

Customer Can you recommend some software for that?

Technician Well, I'm not really ⁸**permitted to** / **allowed to** recommend one brand over another, but perhaps do an internet search to see which providers are trustworthy. That ⁹**should** / **must** help you decide which one to use.

Customer That's great, thanks.



ACTIVATION

Write five rules that you think would make your English class (even) better! Use the grammar from **b** above.
I think it would be really good if we were allowed to use our phones more in class.